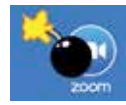




The Covidiot's are here

Human stupidity can be particularly damaging in times of emergencies.
<https://digit.in/apr20-85>



Beware of Zoombombing

Trolls are jumping into Zoom calls and abusing screenshare to flash inappropriate content.
<https://digit.in/apr20-86>

CORONA GO

The pandemic combined with social distancing have suddenly upended the world

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CANCELLED EVENTS AND QUARANTINE CONCERTS

Almost every industry is taking a hit because of the pandemic. In tech, E3, MWC, I/O 2020, SXW, GDC and F8 got cancelled this year. Apple and Microsoft are having digital versions of their WWDC and Build events. Digital Extremes is contemplating an online Tennocon. In sports, F1 cancelled the races, then replaced them with Virtual Grand Prix Series with the drivers joining in remotely. The fate of the Olympics remains a mystery. Closer back home the Road Safety World Series was conducted in closed stadiums with fans getting back their ticket money. Shawn Mendes, Jewel, Camila Cabello and Shawn Mendes all are streaming shows for their fans, with Warner Music and Sony Music hosting streaming concerts as well, featuring artists that they have signed on. This is something that we like for sure. Yes, even the cancelled trade events, which was the responsible thing to do.



VIRTUAL EXPERIENCE ECONOMY

In XR (AR/VR/MR etc) circles, this term was being thrown about as early as 2010. The idea is to build up the technical infrastructure necessary to have immersive mass participation events where people can join from anywhere in the world. This would require an advancement of VR tech as well as 5G. OnePlus for example has taken steps in this direction, and has launched their phones in virtual events before. These kinds

of experiences were projected to be big for the MICE (meetings, incentives, conferences and exhibitions) industry, and the outbreak as well as the cancelled events together have given a push for research and interest in this area, especially considering that there might be big profits to be made.



ZOOM

One of the apps that has demonstrated its functionality in this time of crisis is Zoom.

From employees who have been forced to suddenly work from home, to teachers who want to continue teaching their students, to healthcare professionals interacting with their patients, to groups of kids who just want to hang out and chill, this nifty little video conferencing app turned out to be just the thing they needed. While it's low latency video conferencing was making it a favorite in tech circles, particularly in Silicon Valley, the implementation of social distancing caused the app to trend on the Play Store, and cross 10 million downloads.



PANIC BUYING

Oh well, there is not much to be said for this. Going out to a shop just to hoard everything just shows that you are just a special kind of dirtbag. Hand sanitisers and toilet paper are still understandable, there was a couple in Kentucky who found out that they would not be allowed to buy 552 cans of Mountain Dew. There were serpentine lines outside some stores,



with a Costco opening in Australia turning into a free for all. Gathering in shopping malls en masse can actually help the virus spread. There is also the other extreme, where people panic and don't buy what they otherwise should have. According to a report in Mint, fake forwards on WhatsApp about chicken spreading the disease has led to a loss of ₹1.6 billion a day to the Indian poultry industry. We can only facepalm while simultaneously shaking our heads.



#HOMESCHOOLING

This is just one of those heart-warming trends, with teachers finally getting the recognition they deserve. So parents have found out exactly how much of a trouble managing small kids is, and how much more of a bother it is to get them to learn something. Some parents simply were not up to the task, and have either closed their homeschools, or made out schedules consisting entirely out of Frozen and Frozen 2. All the parents do agree that the teachers were right to complain about their kids all along, and that they really do deserve massive raises.



DOOMSURFING

Let's face it, the internet looks pretty bleak at the moment. There is just too much information as well as misinformation flying around, and it can be quite taxing to filter out the relevant information. Additionally, people don't seem to trust the official figures by the World Health Organisation, leading to all kinds of scary conspiracy theories. Processing all this conflicting information is enough to give anyone information overload. The trick is to not panic at all, and not let all the scary stuff bog you down. Just stay calm, do not freak out, and pass on only specific and relevant information. Because if you do panic, you have fallen prey to doomsurfing. 📺